

Toilet Clog Diy Solutions Guide — Action Checklist

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DIAGNOSE BEFORE ACTING

- ☐ **Diagnose Before Acting, Item 1:** Pour a bucket of water directly into the toilet bowl and watch what happens to determine if you have a soft clog (water drains slowly) or hard clog (water doesn't move).
- ☐ **Diagnose Before Acting, Item 2:** Push the plunger down once hard and watch the water in the bowl to confirm the drain is open before committing to plunging as your solution method.
- ☐ **Diagnose Before Acting, Item 3:** Identify whether the clog is likely caused by excessive toilet paper, foreign objects, or sediment buildup based on who used the toilet and when the problem started.
- ☐ **Diagnose Before Acting, Item 4:** Stop plunging immediately if the water doesn't move at all on your test push — you risk splashing sewage and wasting effort on a clog that needs mechanical clearing.

USE THE RIGHT PLUNGER

- ☐ **Use the Right Plunger, Item 1:** Buy a toilet-specific plunger with a rubber flange (the T-shaped piece) extending below the cup — sink plungers with flat cups cannot seal against a toilet's curved bowl.
- ☐ **Use the Right Plunger, Item 2:** Insert the plunger at a 45-degree angle with the flange going into the drain first, then press down firmly so the rubber cup fully covers the opening and creates a tight seal.
- ☐ **Use the Right Plunger, Item 3:** Pump the plunger aggressively with 6 to 8 hard, full strokes — pump slowly on the push and forcefully on the pull to maximize pressure changes that dislodge the clog.
- ☐ **Use the Right Plunger, Item 4:** Give plunging exactly three serious attempts with aggressive technique before stopping — if the clog hasn't moved after three rounds, switch to the toilet auger immediately.

MOVE TO THE AUGER

- ☐ **Move to the Auger, Item 1:** Purchase a toilet auger (closet auger) for \$25–\$40 at any hardware store — this is the same \$35 tool plumbers use to justify their \$200 service call.
 - ☐ **Move to the Auger, Item 2:** Insert the auger cable into the toilet drain at a shallow angle while rotating the handle clockwise to extend the cable without scraping or cracking the porcelain bowl.
 - ☐ **Move to the Auger, Item 3:** Continue cranking and feeding the cable until you feel resistance (the blockage), then rotate sharply to hook or break up the clog before slowly pulling the cable back out.
 - ☐ **Move to the Auger, Item 4:** Test the toilet with a trial flush after using the auger — if it drains normally the clog is cleared, but call a plumber if two auger attempts fail to restore normal drainage.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.